Butler's paradoxical definition of an exilic Jewishness without Judaism that recognizes alterity draws not only on Rose but also on Hannah Arendt. Yet Arendt was sharply critical of the essentialized Jewishness devoid of religious or social ties, typical of assimilated German Jews in the nineteenth century.[42] Butler claims the higher moral ground in delegitimizing Israel for, among other reasons, the universal lessons from the Holocaust. Since thinkers like Rose and Butler declare that they speak "as Jews" their voices are deemed to have authority.[43]

Conclusion: Postcolonial Rereading of History

Bryan Cheyette has complained that postcolonial theory, as a discipline, rejects the connection of Jewish history with the Holocaust and has placed Jews under the rubric of "Judeo-Christian" civilization, an exclusive club in which they were rarely accepted.[44] Some postcolonial theorists deny the uniqueness of the Holocaust altogether and extrapolate the history of Jewish persecution in Europe to the general experience of slavery and colonialism around the world. In fact, postcolonial theory tends to detach the Holocaust from the history of antisemitism and to reduce the Nazi Final Solution to being a product of European colonialism, whose first laboratory is said to be the Belgian Congo. After all, David Theo Goldberg contends, the Nazis discriminated not just against Jews, but also against gays, Gypsies and others.[45] Even when a postcolonial reading of the Holocaust does not relativize the systematic extermination of the Jews, the "multidirectional" approach to genocide tends to universalize the Jewish historical experience as common to many, if not all, oppressed peoples.[46]

Aamar Mufti's rereading of a number of literary texts in the context of Europe's export of the "Jewish Question" to the Indian subcontinent invites a parallel between the British partition of India in 1947 and the establishment of Israel following the United Nations Partition Plan in November of that year and the War of Independence that broke out soon after.[47] "Partition Studies" have redrawn the historical map of colonialism in order to understand the formation of nations as acts of violence that divide up territory, peoples, and cultures not only in the Middle East and the Indian subcontinent, but also in Europe in the aftermath of German defeat in 1945.[48]

In the postcolonial remapping of history, the Jews have an ambiguous place as paradigmatic migrants. Yet they are also racialized as White Europeans, whose victimization is turned against them as the cause of violence done to Others. The argument about whether, from a postcolonial viewpoint, Israel is a settler society is all too often a function of political

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